

KEEP THIS ONE; IT LIVES NEXT TO YOUR SEND BUTTON

AI for Communication: Parent Messages, Translation, and Tone

THE STANCE

AI drafts the message; you make it yours. Families hear you, not the tool.

And hard news is never delivered by a draft: you call.

Why one sentence matters

In a field experiment, one individualized sentence home per week cut the share of students failing to earn course credit from 15.8% to 9.3%, a 41% reduction, with improvement-focused messages working best (Kraft & Rogers, 2015). Personal-at-scale used to cost hours. It doesn't anymore.

Prompt 1 · The weekly message

"You are a warm, organized teacher. Draft this week's family [newsletter / update] for my class. Context: [what happened, what's coming, what families must do and by when]. Format: under 150 words, skimmable on a phone, action items as a short bulleted list, one positive line about the class's week."

Prompt 2 · The difficult email (tone repair)

"Draft a calm, professional reply to a frustrated parent who [general situation, no names]. Acknowledge the frustration, explain that specifics belong in a conversation, offer two meeting times, keep it under 120 words, firm and warm."

The 24-hour rule: anything written angry waits a day unless safety can't wait. The vent draft gets deleted, not sent.

Prompt 3 · The positive-note batch

"Write 12 one-sentence positive note starters a teacher could send to families, warm and improvement-focused, grouped by situation (persistence, kindness, turnaround, leadership, progress). No student names; I'll personalize each one myself."

Pick three a week. Personalize each in your own email, where names belong. That's the research-backed habit, at five minutes a week.

Translation, responsibly (the four rules)

- **Plain language first:** short sentences, no idioms; plain English translates well, clever English translates badly.
- **Official documents go district:** rights, discipline, special education travel your district's translation channel, not a chatbot.
- **Human check when stakes rise:** a bilingual colleague, aide, or liaison reviews; machine translation is helpful and imperfect.
- **The privacy rule speaks every language:** no student details in a public tool, in any language.

Why it matters: 5.3 million U.S. students (10.6%) are English learners (NCES), and federal guidance requires communicating with families in a language they can understand (ED/DOJ, 2015). Your access plan is how your classroom meets that promise.

My access plan (three lines)

Languages my families read: _____

Official documents travel via: _____

My human check for translated messages: _____

The tone-repair kit

Tool	Use it when
"Warmer." "Shorter." "Plainer."	Ninety percent of drafts need exactly one of these
The read-aloud test	Your ear knows your voice; if it doesn't sound like you, retype it the way you'd say it
The 24-hour rule	Anything written angry; tomorrow-you sends better email

The human-only list (never a draft)

Safety concerns · serious discipline · a family's grief · special-education decisions. For these, call first, in your own voice. Written follow-up comes later, written by you.

The permanent rules ride along: the situation, never the child, goes into the tool. And nothing AI-drafted reaches a family unread and unpersonalized.

Three families getting a positive note this week (initials only, kept by you)

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